SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #45 · SALVATION

“Being raised in a Christian family makes me a Christian.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Growing up in church and always identifying as a Christian. Being baptized or confirmed as a child without understanding it. Parents or grandparents with strong faith. A culture where being Christian is part of family or national identity. Never being asked whether you personally trust Christ.

What Scripture teaches

A Christian family is a great blessing, and God often uses parents to plant faith in children. But each person must personally receive Christ. To all who receive Him and believe in His name, God gives the right to become His children, born not of human descent but of God. Jesus said no one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again. John the Baptist warned people not to rely on having Abraham as their father. Faith cannot be inherited; it must be your own.

> *“But to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God—children born not of blood, nor of the desire or will of man, but born of God”* **(John 1:12–13)**.

Also see

> “Jesus replied, ‘Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again.’” **(John 3:3)**.

> “That if you confess with your mouth, ‘Jesus is Lord,’ and believe in your heart that God raised Him from the dead, you will be saved. For with your heart you believe and are justified, and with your mouth you confess and are saved” **(Romans 10:9–10)**.

> “And do not presume to say to yourselves, ‘We have Abraham as our father.’ For I tell you that out of these stones God can raise up children for Abraham” **(Matthew 3:9)**.

> “Examine yourselves to see whether you are in the faith; test yourselves. Can’t you see for yourselves that Jesus Christ is in you—unless you actually fail the test?” **(2 Corinthians 13:5)**.

Common self-statements

- I was born a Christian.
- My parents’ faith covers me.
- I’ve always gone to church, so I’m fine.
- I was baptized as a baby, so I don’t need anything else.
- My family name speaks for me.
- I don’t need a personal relationship with Jesus.

Common logical errors

- **Assuming without checking:** Taking your faith for granted without examining it.
- **Confusing identity with relationship:** Treating a family or cultural label as a personal faith.
- **Borrowed faith:** Relying on someone else’s relationship with God.
- **Avoidance:** Not asking the question because you fear the answer.

Challenging questions

- Who does John 1:12 say becomes a child of God?
- What did Jesus mean by “born again”?
- If my parents had no faith, would I still believe?
- Have I ever personally trusted Christ, or just grown up around Him?

- What does Romans 10:9 say I must do?
- Is my faith my own or borrowed?
- What would it mean to make my family's faith my own?

Truth summary

> Being raised in a Christian family is a blessing, but it does not make me a Christian. I become God's child by personally receiving Jesus and believing in His name. My faith must be my own. I can thank God for my family's faith and personally put my trust in Christ.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Born Again
- Salvation
- Faith
- Children
- Belief

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Belief/Salvation
- Parenting

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Born Again — Newsboys
Describes faith as a personal new birth, not something inherited from family.

I Surrender All — Reawaken Hymns
Faith is my own surrender to Jesus, not a family tradition.

Jesus Messiah — Chris Tomlin
Keeps my eyes on what Christ personally did for me.

Come Thou Fount of Every Blessing — Chris Rice
A personal confession of how much I depend on God's grace.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Being raised in a Christian family makes me a Christian"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Being raised in a Christian family makes me a Christian." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who becomes a child of God?
- ☐ What does "born again" mean for me?
- ☐ Would I believe if my parents didn't?
- ☐ Have I personally trusted Christ?
- ☐ What does Romans 10:9 ask of me?
- ☐ Is my faith my own or borrowed?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I become God's child by receiving Jesus personally.
- ☐ My faith must be my own, not inherited.
- ☐ God has no grandchildren, only children.
- ☐ A Christian family is a blessing, not a substitute.
- ☐ I can personally trust Christ today.
- ☐ If I confess Jesus as Lord and believe, I am saved.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **John 1:12–13**
  "But to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God— children born not of blood, nor of the desire or will of man, but born of God."
- [ ] **John 3:3**
  "Jesus replied, 'Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again.'"
- [ ] **Romans 10:9–10**
  "That if you confess with your mouth, 'Jesus is Lord,' and believe in your heart that God raised Him from the dead, you will be saved. For with your heart you believe and are justified, and with your mouth you confess and are saved."
- [ ] **Matthew 3:9**
  "And do not presume to say to yourselves, 'We have Abraham as our father.' For I tell you that out of these stones God can raise up children for Abraham."
- [ ] **2 Corinthians 13:5**
  "Examine yourselves to see whether you are in the faith; test yourselves. Can't you see for yourselves that Jesus Christ is in you—unless you actually fail the test?"

A verse I found myself: _____

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Listen to one song each day** from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **My faith journal:** Each day, write one thing I personally believe about Jesus and why.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, John 1:12 becomes: "But to **Sarah**, who did receive Him and believed in His name, He gave the right to become a child of God."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Born Again" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Write your own faith story:** when and how you came to trust Christ for yourself, or what is holding you back.
- ☐ **Read John 3:1–21,** and write what Jesus told Nicodemus, a very religious man.
- ☐ **Pray a personal prayer of faith in your own words,** telling Jesus you trust Him as your Savior and Lord.
- ☐ **Ask a parent or grandparent** how their faith became their own, and share yours with them.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Being raised in a Christian family makes me a Christian": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One thing I believe for myself
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Being raised in a Christian family makes me a Christian.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, thank You for the people who taught me about You. Help me reject the lie that being raised in a Christian family makes me a Christian. I personally receive You and believe in Your name. Make my faith my own, and help me follow You for the rest of my life. In Your name, Amen.

✦ ✦ ✦

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.